

DOCUMENTATION · VI.0.2

SYNODE

Σύνοδος

Design system, CSS architecture, elegance review, image catalogue, image protection and intellectual-property guide for the synode.space parallax photography landing page.

Style guide: Hellenic Manuscript & Classical Serif

Files: [index.html](#) · [terms.html](#) · [css/site.css](#) · [css/layout.css](#) · [js/parallax.js](#) · [js/protect.js](#)

6 October 2026

I · OVERVIEW

Synode is a single-scroll fashion photography journal for *synode.space*. There is no main menu: the page reads top to bottom like a manuscript, in seven movements. Depth comes from slow parallax on photographs, sticky captions that hold while plates drift past, and stacked leaves that settle over one another. Everything else is restraint: parchment ground, ink type, hairline gold rules and one rust accent.

PAGE SEQUENCE

#	SECTION	TECHNIQUE	CLASS
I	Hero — title inscription over a full-bleed plate	Two-layer parallax: plate 0.35 down, inscription 0.12 up	<code>.hero</code>
II	Prologue — wide-margin text with drop cap	Asymmetric folio grid, reveal on enter	<code>.folio</code>
III	Chapter I · Aegean	Sticky caption column + plates drifting at ± 0.05 –0.08	<code>.chapter</code>
IV	Interlude — inscription band	Full-bleed parallax background, 0.2	<code>.interlude</code>
V	Chapter II · Terracotta	CSS sticky stacked leaves, offset like folio pages	<code>.stack</code>
VI	Chapter III · Laurel	Asymmetric 12-column contact sheet	<code>.gallery</code>
VII	Colophon — contact, copyright, terms link	Static dark ground	<code>.colophon</code>

FILE STRUCTURE

<code>index.html</code>	single page, semantic sections, no <code><nav></code>
<code>terms.html</code>	terms of use (linked from the colophon only)
<code>css/site.css</code>	tokens, base, typography, ornament, components, reveal
<code>css/layout.css</code>	sections, responsive, image protection, print, terms page
<code>js/parallax.js</code>	parallax offsets + reveal, no dependencies
<code>js/protect.js</code>	blocks save/drag on photographs only
<code>images/plates/</code>	12 photographs under fixed names (see §4)
<code>images/og/share.jpg</code>	link-preview card
<code>images/README.md</code>	catalogue + drop-in checklist
<code>robots.txt</code>	blocks AI-training crawlers, allows search
<code>.well-known/tdmrep.json</code>	machine-readable text & data mining opt-out
<code>.htaccess</code>	hotlink protection, rights headers, no listings (Apache)
<code>docs/src/</code>	document sources, PDF build, placeholder generator
<code>docs/synode-v1.0.2.pdf</code>	this document (v1.0.1 kept for history)

Load order is `site.css` then `layout.css`: layout consumes the tokens declared in site.

2 · CSS styling summary

COLOUR TOKENS

TOKEN	HEX	ROLE	SHARE
 <code>--parchment-marble</code>	#F7F4EE	Page canvas	60%
 <code>--aegean-ink</code>	#0C1821	Type; hero, interlude, colophon grounds	30%
 <code>--amphora-rust</code>	#A34828	Drop caps, eyebrows, plate numbers, button, focus	10%
 <code>--hellenic-gold</code>	#C29B38	1px rules at 0.4 opacity; text only on ink	
 <code>--laurel-leaf</code>	#516053	Captions, meta, secondary notes	—
 <code>--thera-white</code>	#FFFFFF	Stacked leaf cards, button text	—

Semantic aliases (`--color-bg`, `--color-text`, `--color-muted`, `--color-accent`, `--color-ornament`, `--color-surface`) sit above the palette so a future dark or seasonal theme only remaps six lines.

TYPE SCALE (FLUID, 360 → 1440PX)

LEVEL	CLASS	FAMILY / WEIGHT	SIZE	TRACKING
Display H1	<code>.display</code>	Cinzel 900, uppercase	48 → 72px	+0.15em
Section H2	<code>.section-title</code>	Bodoni Moda 600 (optical size auto)	32 → 40px	+0.05em
Subsection H3	<code>.subhead</code>	Cinzel 400, uppercase	20 → 24px	+0.20em
Body	<code>body</code>	EB Garamond 400, old-style figures	16 → 18px / 1.65	0
Caption / meta	<code>.caption</code> <code>.meta</code>	Spectral italic 400	13 → 14px	+0.02em
Eyebrow	<code>.eyebrow</code>	Cinzel 400, uppercase, rust	12px	+0.30em
Drop cap	<code>.dropcap</code>	Cinzel Decorative 700, rust; <code>initial-letter: 3</code> where supported	3 lines	—
Greek	<code>.hero__greek</code>	GFS Didot (Greek only), gold on ink	20 → 28px	+0.08em

The reading column is capped at 62ch. Display type receives a negative right margin equal to its tracking so centred capitals are optically, not mathematically, centred.

LAYOUT

- **Folio grid** — three columns: gloss margin (min 9rem), reading column (max 40rem), and a deliberately empty outer margin 1.6× wider. Padding is 5% left, 10% right on desktop, collapsing to max(16px, 6%)

below 960px.

- **Sticky chapter** — caption column is `position: sticky; top: 18vh`; plates sit on a 6-column sub-grid with alternating offsets (1–5, 3–7, 1–7).
- **Stacked leaves** — each leaf is a 100svh sticky container; leaves 2 and 3 rest 1.25rem lower so the previous edge stays visible. On phones (<720px) stacking is switched off and leaves simply follow each other.
- **Contact sheet** — 12 columns with negative and positive margin offsets for an asymmetric, hand-laid feel; two columns on phones.

MOTION

- Parallax writes a single custom property, `--py`, consumed by `transform: translate3d()`. Only transforms animate, so scrolling stays on the compositor.
- An IntersectionObserver keeps only on-screen layers in the update set; updates are batched in `requestAnimationFrame`. Native scrolling is never intercepted.
- Speeds are deliberately small: 0.02–0.12 for plates, 0.2–0.35 for backgrounds. Background layers are oversized (`inset: -12% / -25%`) so no edge can show.
- Text blocks fade up 1.5rem over 900ms on `cubic-bezier(.22, .61, .36, 1)`, once.
- `prefers-reduced-motion` disables parallax, reveal, the scroll cue and image zoom, and turns off smooth scrolling.

3 · Elegance review

Review of the pasted Hellenic Manuscript guide as a system for a fashion photography site, with what v1.0.1 already does about each point.

Palette restraint & temperature	9 / 10
Type pairing (display / section / body)	8 / 10
Accessibility of the palette as specified	6 / 10
Spacing & manuscript proportion	9 / 10
Economy (number of typefaces)	6 / 10
Overall, as written	8 / 10

WHAT IS ALREADY ELEGANT

- **Warm, not white.** Ink on parchment gives 16.4:1 contrast without the glare of #000 on #FFF. Photography reads richer on a warm ground, and the parchment tint lets plates float.
- **The 60/30/10 split maps naturally onto a scroll page:** parchment for reading, ink for the three cinematic bands (hero, interlude, colophon), rust and gold only as points of light.
- **Lapidary capitals + Didone + Garamond** is a historically coherent trio: Roman inscription for titles, eighteenth-century high contrast for sections, Renaissance text face for reading.

- **Hairline gold at 40% opacity** is the right strength: it reads as ruling on a page, not as decoration.
- **Asymmetric margins** give the photographs room and stop the page from looking like a template.

CONTRAST AUDIT (WCAG 2.2)

FOREGROUND	ON PARCHMENT	ON AEGEAN INK
Aegean Ink	16.37 AAA	—
Amphora Rust	5.44 AA	3.01 large text only
Hellenic Gold	2.38 fails	6.88 AA
Laurel Leaf	6.08 AA	2.69 fails
White on Rust (button)	5.97 AA	

The one real problem in the guide: it assigns Hellenic Gold to “metadata”. On parchment, gold text is 2.38:1 and unreadable for many people. v1.0.1 resolves this by setting meta in Laurel on light grounds and allowing gold text only on Aegean Ink (`.meta--gold`, hero, colophon). Gold on parchment is used for rules only.

REFINEMENTS RECOMMENDED FOR V1.1

1. **Fewer voices.** The guide calls on six families (Cinzel, Cinzel Decorative, Bodoni Moda, GFS Didot, EB Garamond, Spectral). EB Garamond's own italic is one of the finest and could replace Spectral; Cinzel Decorative can be subset to the few drop-cap letters with Google Fonts' `&text=` parameter. That cuts roughly a third of the font payload and tightens the page's voice.
2. **“Thick, high-contrast” headers.** Cinzel is an inscriptional face with low stroke contrast; the high contrast lives in Bodoni Moda. The guide's wording conflates the two. Consider Cinzel 700 instead of 900 for the hero: at 72px with +0.15em tracking, 900 starts to look heavy beside fine photography.
3. **Didone tracking.** +0.05em suits all-caps, but loosens lowercase Bodoni. For title-case H2s, +0.01–0.02em keeps the hairlines crisp. (This document already uses +0.02em for its H2s for comparison.)
4. **Thera White vs parchment.** Pure #FFF next to #F7F4EE can read slightly cool. Keep it for the stacked leaves, where the lift is intentional, but don't spread it to other surfaces.
5. **GFS Didot** should stay for Greek text only (as in the hero's Σύντομος). For Latin H2s, Bodoni Moda has the better Latin glyphs and optical sizes.
6. **Rust on ink** (3.01:1) works for the colophon button, where white text sits on a rust fill, but never set rust text directly on ink below 24px.

4 • Image catalogue

Since v1.0.2 every photograph is served from the site's own `images/` folder, under fixed filenames. Up to v1.0.1 the demo hotlinked random placeholder photos from `picsum.photos`, a third-party service; that link has been removed and nothing loads from it any more. Each slot now holds a labelled placeholder showing its filename and size.

FILE (IMAGES/...)	PLACEMENT	RATIO	EXPORT PX	MOTION	LINE	CAPTION • ALT TEXT TO REWRITE
<code>plates/hero.jpg</code>	Opening screen	3:2	2400×1600	0.35	l. 36	Decorative (alt left empty). Title sits on the centre: choose a frame with a quiet middle.
<code>plates/plate-01.jpg</code>	Ch. I Aegean, 1st	5:7	1000×1400	0.08	l. 80	01 Indigo column dress • “Model in an indigo linen column dress...”
<code>plates/plate-02.jpg</code>	Ch. I Aegean, 2nd	5:6	1000×1200	−0.06	l. 84	02 Salt-white tunic • “Draped white cotton tunic...”
<code>plates/plate-03.jpg</code>	Ch. I Aegean, 3rd	3:2	1500×1000	0.05	l. 88	03 Blue-hour layers • “Two figures in layered blue silk...”
<code>plates/interlude.jpg</code>	Quote band	3:2	2400×1600	0.2	l. 97	Decorative. Darkened 62% under the quote.
<code>plates/plate-04.jpg</code>	Ch. II leaf IV	7:5	1400×1000	sticky	l. 118	Amphora coat • “Rust wool coat...”
<code>plates/plate-05.jpg</code>	Ch. II leaf V	7:5	1400×1000	sticky	l. 129	Ochre pleat • “Ochre pleated skirt in motion...”
<code>plates/plate-06.jpg</code>	Ch. II leaf VI	7:5	1400×1000	sticky	l. 140	Kiln shirt • “Clay-coloured silk shirt...”
<code>plates/plate-07.jpg</code>	Ch. III Laurel, top left	3:4	1200×1600	0.06	l. 159	07 Olive knit • “Olive knit dress in an olive grove”
<code>plates/plate-08.jpg</code>	Ch. III, top right	9:7	1260×980	−0.04	l. 160	08 Gilt cuff, detail • “Detail of a laurel-green sleeve...”
<code>plates/plate-09.jpg</code>	Ch. III, right	9:13	1080×1560	0.1	l. 161	09 Sage overcoat • “Long sage overcoat on a stone stairway”
<code>plates/plate-10.jpg</code>	Ch. III, bottom left	3:2	1500×1000	−0.02	l. 162	10 The gathering, Delos • “Group portrait in muted green tailoring...”
<code>og/share.jpg</code>	Link preview card (social, messaging)	1.91:1	1200×630	—	head	Not shown on the page.

Thirteen files in all: 12 on the page plus the share card. A copy of this table is kept beside the photos in `images/README.md`.

5 • Upload & update guide

Should I just drop the folder? Yes. Filenames are fixed, so replacing the files in `images/plates/` is enough for the photos to appear. You only touch `index.html` to rewrite captions and alt text, and to bump the cache version.

STEP BY STEP

1. **Choose.** Pick one photograph per slot. Proportions close to the “Ratio” column crop best; frames are cropped around the centre.
2. **Export web copies** (Lightroom / Capture One): JPEG, sRGB, quality 75–82, long edge as listed.
Metadata: *All except Camera & Camera Raw info*, with *Remove Location Info* ticked. This keeps your copyright and drops GPS. Never upload originals.
3. **Stamp rights metadata** (if your export preset doesn't already). See §6.
4. **Rename** exactly as catalogued: lowercase, .jpg.
5. **Drop** the files into `images/plates/`, overwriting the placeholders. Put the share card in `images/og/`.
6. **Rewrite text.** In `index.html`, at the lines in the catalogue, update each `alt=“...”` (what the photo shows, for screen readers and search) and its caption.
7. **Bump the cache version.** Find and replace `?v=1.0.2` with `?v=1.0.3` (and so on each time). Without this, returning visitors may keep seeing old files.
8. **Preview locally:** `python -m http.server` in the site folder, then open `http://localhost:8000`.
9. **Upload** to the web root of synode.space via your host's file manager, SFTP or Git deploy.

WHAT TO UPLOAD

```
index.html  terms.html  robots.txt  .htaccess
css/        js/         images/     .well-known/tdmrep.json
```

Do NOT upload: `docs/` `.claude/` `originals` or RAW files

Files starting with a dot (`.htaccess`, `.well-known`) are hidden by many FTP clients. Turn on “show hidden files” so they upload too.

ADJUSTING A CROP

```
<img ... style="object-position: 50% 25%">    first value left→right, second top→bottom
```

ADDING A PLATE

Copy an existing `<figure>` block in `index.html`, point it at the next free name (`plate-11.jpg`), and add a row to `images/README.md`. To make a placeholder for any empty slot, add it to the list in `docs/src/make-`

`placeholders.py` and run it; it never overwrites existing photos.

6 · Image protection: the technical boundary

Plain truth first. Anything a browser can display has already been downloaded to the visitor's device, and anyone can take a screenshot. No website can make images impossible to copy. What a site *can* do is stop casual saving, keep high-resolution files off the web, make ownership provable, and opt out of AI training in a form the law recognises. v1.0.2 does all four.

MEASURE (V1.0.2)	WHERE	STOPS	DOES NOT STOP
Web-size exports only (≤ 2400 px, $q \approx 80$)	Your export	Print-quality or large-format reuse	Reuse at web size
Embedded copyright metadata (IPTC/XMP)	Each JPG	"I didn't know who owned it"; supports §1202 claims	Screenshots and social uploads that strip metadata
Transparent shield over photos; right-click, drag and iOS long-press blocked on images only	<code>layout.css §10</code> , <code>js/protect.js</code>	"Save image as...", drag-to-desktop	Developer tools, page source, screenshots
Photos hidden when printed, with notice	<code>layout.css §10</code>	Print-to-PDF of the page	Screenshots
Hotlink protection	<code>.htaccess</code>	Other sites embedding your files on your bandwidth	Re-uploading a saved copy
No directory listing	<code>.htaccess</code>	Browsing <code>/images/plates/</code> as a file list	Guessing filenames
AI / TDM opt-out: <code>robots.txt</code> , <code>tdmrep.json</code> , tdm-reservation meta + headers, noai	root, <code><head></code> , <code>.htaccess</code>	Compliant AI crawlers; creates a legally recognised EU opt-out	Scrapers that ignore the rules
Copyright line + Terms link in colophon	<code>index.html</code>	Claims of innocent use	—

DELIBERATELY NOT DONE

- **Site-wide right-click blocking.** It breaks copying text, opening links in new tabs and some accessibility tools, and protects nothing extra. Blocking is limited to photographs.
- **Canvas / base64 obfuscation.** Slower pages, worse search ranking, and still defeated by a screenshot.
- **Visible watermarks.** Off by default for elegance. If you want one, a small © in a corner of your highest-value plates, added at export, is the least intrusive form.

STAMPING METADATA WITH EXIFTOOL

```
exiftool -overwrite_original -gps:all= \
  -Artist="[Your name]" -XMP-dc:Creator="[Your name]" \
  -Copyright="© 2026 [Your name]. All rights reserved." \
  -IPTC:CopyrightNotice="© 2026 [Your name]. All rights reserved." \
  -XMP-xmpRights:Marked=True \
  -XMP-xmpRights:WebStatement="https://synode.space/terms.html" \
  -XMP-xmpRights:UsageTerms="No reproduction or AI training without written licence." \
  -XMP-plus:LicensorURL="https://synode.space/terms.html" \
  -XMP-plus:DataMining="DMI-PROHIBITED" \
  images/plates/*.jpg
```

Lightroom equivalent: a Metadata preset with Copyright, Copyright Status = Copyrighted, Rights Usage Terms and Copyright Info URL. Photoshop and Lightroom can also attach **Content Credentials** (C2PA), a signed record that you made the image.

IF YOUR HOST IS NOT APACHE

```
# nginx - inside server { }
location ~* \.(jpe?g|png|webp|avif)$ {
    valid_referers none blocked synode.space www.synode.space;
    if ($invalid_referer) { return 403; }
    add_header X-Robots-Tag "noai, noimageai";
    add_header tdm-reservation "1";
}
location /docs/ { deny all; }
autoindex off;
```

Cloudflare (any host): Scrape Shield → *Hotlink Protection* on; Security → Bots → *Block AI bots* on. **Netlify** / **Vercel** / **GitHub Pages** ignore `.htaccess`; set the same headers in their config files, and rely on Cloudflare for hotlink protection.

WATCHING FOR MISUSE

Search your key plates now and then with Google Lens or TinEye, or use a monitoring service (Pixsy, Copytrack) that finds copies and handles claims. Optional: tools such as Glaze add near-invisible changes that disrupt AI style mimicry, at a small cost in image quality.

7 • Intellectual property: the legal boundary

General information, not legal advice. Law varies by country; have a lawyer in your jurisdiction review the terms before launch, especially if you plan to license images commercially.

WHAT YOU OWN AUTOMATICALLY

Copyright in a photograph belongs to the photographer the moment it is taken, in all 181 countries of the Berne Convention, with no registration or © symbol required. If someone else was hired to shoot for Synode, ownership follows their contract: get a written assignment or licence from them.

WHAT STRENGTHENS IT

- **US registration.** To sue over a US work you must first register it with the US Copyright Office. Registering before infringement (or within three months of publication) also unlocks statutory damages and legal fees, which is usually what makes a claim worth pursuing. Published photos can be registered in groups of up to 750 under one application (GRPPH).
- **Copyright management information.** Removing or altering embedded rights metadata is separately unlawful in the US (17 U.S.C. § 1202) and the EU (InfoSoc Directive Art. 7). That is why \$6 stamps it into every file.
- **AI training opt-out.** In the EU, Article 4(3) of the DSM Directive lets rights-holders reserve their works from text and data mining, but for online content only in machine-readable form. robots.txt, tdmrep.json and the **tdm-reservation** meta and header provide exactly that. The EU AI Act requires general-purpose AI providers to respect such reservations.
- **Records.** Keep RAW files, shoot dates and model releases. They are your proof of authorship.

WHAT YOU MUST SECURE FROM OTHERS

- **Model releases** for every recognisable person, covering web publication and, if you plan to license images, use by third parties.
- **Designers and brands.** Editorial display of garments is generally fine. Commercial licensing of images that feature a brand's logo or distinctive design may need that brand's consent.
- **Locations.** Some archaeological sites (including on Delos) require permits for professional photography; keep them on file.

WHERE TERMS OF USE FIT

Copyright is the primary protection; the Terms of Use add a contract layer that states plainly what is forbidden (downloading, AI training, hotlinking, metadata removal) and how to get a licence. Terms shown by a footer link ("browsewrap") are weaker contracts than terms a visitor clicks to accept, but they remove any claim of innocent use and support takedown notices.

WHEN YOU FIND A COPY

1. Screenshot the use with URL and date.
2. Send a takedown notice to the host or platform (DMCA in the US; Digital Services Act notice in the EU). Most platforms have a form.
3. For commercial misuse, a licence-fee demand through a lawyer or a monitoring service is common practice.

PRIVACY NOTE

The page loads fonts from Google Fonts, which passes visitors' IP addresses to Google. A German court (LG München, 2022) held this unlawful without consent under GDPR. If you expect EU visitors, self-hosting the fonts is the safer path; the Terms disclose the current setup. If your host adds analytics or cookies, update Terms §9.

8 • Terms of Use

`terms.html` is a new, separately styled page, linked from the colophon. It does not add a menu: the landing page still scrolls without navigation. Its twelve sections:

§	SECTION	PURPOSE
1	Who we are	Names the legal owner
2	Ownership	Copyright statement, all rights reserved
3–4	What you may / may not do	View and link only; no download, reuse, editing, metadata removal, hotlinking, scraping or AI training
5	Text & data mining reservation	EU Art. 4(3) opt-out, pointing to the machine-readable files
6	Licensing	How to request a licence: written and confirmed only
7	People, garments, third parties	Model consent does not pass to visitors
8	Reporting infringement	DMCA / DSA notices and enforcement
9–12	Privacy, liability, governing law, changes	Standard closing terms

Before launch, fill the bracketed fields shown in rust with a dashed underline in `terms.html`: legal name of the owner, registered address, and jurisdiction (twice). Search the file for `class="fill"`.

9 • Production notes

TONAL FILTER

A light tonal filter (`saturate(.82) sepia(.12)`) pulls mixed sources toward the palette. If your grading is already final, remove it in `layout.css` §1. For further performance, add AVIF/WebP versions with `srcset` later; the fixed-filename JPGs remain the fallback.

ADDING A PARALLAX LAYER

```
<figure class="plate" data-speed="0.06">  positive = slower than scroll, negative =  
faster  
  <div class="plate__frame"><img ...></div>  
  <figcaption class="caption"><span class="caption__no">11</span> ...</figcaption>  
</figure>
```

Background layers need headroom: $\text{inset} \geq \text{speed} \times (\text{viewport} + \text{section height}) / 2$.

BROWSER SUPPORT

Evergreen Chromium, Firefox and Safari. `color-mix()`, `svh`, `text-wrap: balance` and `initial-letter` degrade gracefully: fallbacks are provided for viewport units and the drop cap, and balance is cosmetic.

REBUILDING THIS PDF

```
sh docs/src/build-pdf.sh 1.0.2
```

CHANGELOG

1.0.2 — Images moved from `picsum.photos` to local `images/` with fixed filenames and labelled placeholders; full image catalogue and upload guide; image protection (shield overlay, scoped save/drag blocking, print notice, hotlink protection, AI/TDM opt-out via `robots.txt`, `tdmrep.json`, meta and headers); copyright line in colophon; new Terms of Use page; IP and legal guide.

1.0.1 — Gold restricted to dark grounds; interlude quote measure fixed; parallax measures each layer's own position; stacked leaves disabled on phones.

1.0.0 — Initial single-scroll layout, tokens and parallax engine.